

Summer Fruit Soup

Jacques Pépin cleverly uses strawberry jam and black currant liqueur to sweeten this dessert. He stirs them into white wine, then adds plums, cherries, grapes, and berries and quickly poaches them. Basil adds a light, savory note.

By Jacques Pépin | Updated on July 1, 2014

Chill Time: 45 mins

Total Time: 1 hr 15 mins

Servings: 6 to 8

Ingredients

½ cup dry white wine, such as Sauvignon Blanc

½ cup crème de cassis (black currant liqueur)

¼ cup pomegranate juice

2 tablespoons strawberry preserves

1 teaspoon orange zest, finely grated

½ pound small red plums, halved, pitted, and cut into 1/2-inch wedges

½ pound Bing cherries, pitted

2 sprigs basil

½ pound seedless red grapes

½ pound strawberries, hulled and quartered

6 ounces blueberries

1 cup sour cream

1 tablespoon sugar

Mint leaves, for garnish

Toasted brioche slices, for serving (optional)

Directions

Step 1

In a medium saucepan, combine the white wine with the crème de cassis, pomegranate juice, strawberry preserves, and orange zest. Bring to a boil, stirring to dissolve the preserves.

Step 2

Add the plums, cherries, and basil to the saucepan and return to a boil, then simmer over medium-high heat for 1 minute. Using a slotted spoon, transfer the fruit to a large glass or ceramic bowl. Add the grapes to the saucepan and simmer for 30 seconds; transfer the grapes to the bowl. Add the strawberries and blueberries to the saucepan and simmer for 2 minutes. Transfer the berries and cooking juices to the bowl and let cool completely; discard the basil sprigs. Cover and refrigerate the fruit soup until chilled, about 45 minutes.

Step 3

In a small bowl, whisk the sour cream with the sugar. Spoon the fruit soup into shallow bowls and dollop the sweetened sour cream on top. Garnish with mint leaves and serve with toasted brioche, if you like.

Make ahead

The fruit soup can be refrigerated overnight.

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